

English Literature

(A Level, AQA specification A)

English Literature offers an opportunity like no other A Level: the chance to explore the lives, narratives and worlds of others. Through reading some of the greatest works of the literary imagination, you will dive into strange and unique worlds, vicariously live lives that you never dreamed possible and experience the joys and struggles of your fellow man. Through analysing the literary canon, you will develop close analysis skills and your own unique interpretations of texts. You will cultivate a love of language and the writer's craft. In classroom debates and critical discussion, you will be challenged to voice your own opinions and your critical imagination will flourish.

Entry Requirements:

Grade 5 in GCSE English Literature. To complete this course, you are also expected to be a committed reader who is prepared to read widely throughout the course.

Course Content

Units	%	When?	Content
Paper 1: Love Through the Ages (3 hours)	40%	End of Year 13	You will study three texts that will allow you to explore the theme of 'Love Through the Ages'. This unit will also allow you to develop your confidence in responding to unseen poetry texts. The three-hour examination will test your close reading skills as well as your broader knowledge of the texts you have studied.
Paper 2: Texts in Shared Contexts. (2 hours 30 minutes)	40%	End of Year 13	This 2 ½ hour examination will allow you to study a further three texts of all genres. You will explore the key concerns of Twentieth Century Literature through reading and comparing texts that explore the post Second World War world. The exam will require you to respond to unseen texts as well as writing individual and comparative essays on the texts you have studied.
Non-examined assessment: Independent Critical Study	20%	Term 3 of Year 13	In this non examined assessment you will have the opportunity to write a sustained, 2,500 word comparative essay of two texts, one of which must be written before 1900. In this essay you will be expected to prove that you have the skills to be a confident, independent reader through selecting a text of your own that you wish to compare to a text you have studied in class.

Costs associated with this course

You will need to buy your own copies of: Othello, The Handmaid's Tale and Feminine Gospels. There will be some additional texts which you will need to purchase during the course. Your teacher will advise on these.

Career Links

English Literature is a rigorous and highly academic A Level that is sought after by all Russell Group universities. Students of English Literature can go on to study Law, History, Politics, Journalism, Advertising and Media, as well as literature-based degree courses. The critical thinking, creative skills and development of a formal, professional writing style offered by the subject make it a perfect complement to arts or science subjects. Students who have taken English Literature at Backwell have gone on to study English Literature at degree level or have taken higher education courses in such subjects as Sociology, History, Psychology or Journalism. Literature students have gone on to gain employment in a range of areas.

For more information please contact Miss Jackson

